

The Smell of Wet Towels

One of those days, could've been the day before... but no. Pretty sure it was the next one..

I was biking through the village, just trying to get some fresh air, when I started to smell it. Something familiar. Something I knew very well.

But I couldn't quite place it. I found myself sniffing the air like a wild animal, short breaths, searching, nostrils flaring like antennas. The smell was everywhere.

And then it hit me.

Wet towels. But not just any wet towels.

A towel after a long day at the beach. Left in a bag. Still damp, starting to turn. That specific, heavy, salty smell, right on the edge of becoming something else.

It was as if the sea itself had packed a bag and left it open in the village, letting its scent drift through the streets for no reason at all.

It brought me straight back to the Cantabrian Sea when I was a child. Long days in the water with my cousins, fighting the waves like it meant something. The Atlantic was always freezing, even in summer. We'd run back to the pool every ten minutes just to warm up.

Our lips would turn purple, but we'd go straight back in anyway.

And somehow, that smell, that damp towel smell, had been waiting there all along. Decades later, it found me again.